



2ND WEEK: **DAY 13**

Feeling close

YOUR BABY TODAY

It's inevitable that your baby will be exposed to viruses and some believe this reduces the risk of allergies later on. However, small babies can be quite sick with a cold, so try to avoid people with colds at first. Breastfeeding provides protection against viruses.

“Now that you and your partner are adapting to your new roles, you can start to think about how to make time for each other.”

Finding time alone together can be hard and resuming your love life can take time. Some women resume their love life without any problems, but for many it takes a little longer, especially if they had stitches and are sore. Also, a difficult birth can affect you emotionally, as can fatigue from lack of sleep. It's recommended that you wait two to three weeks after giving birth before sexual intercourse to let your uterus reduce in size and for the bleeding to stop. Many women prefer to wait until after their [six-week checkup](#). Initially, cuddling and having nonpenetrative sex can help you and your partner experience closeness. When you both feel right, you can resume sex, but the first time needs to be gentle and you may need a lubricant since your hormones can cause vaginal dryness, especially with breastfeeding. If intercourse is painful, talk to your doctor, who can make sure you're healing.

You will need to consider contraception now (see [Questions and answers](#)). If you're undecided as to what to use and want to resume intercourse, use condoms until your six week checkup when you can discuss the issue.